AOU
الجامعة العربية المفتوحة
Arab Open University

Faculty of Faculty of Business Studies

BUS310 - Strategic Management: Creating Competitive Advantages

Final Examination (Form B)

2024-2025/Fall

11- January- 2025

Number of Exam Pages: 2 (including this cover sheet)	**Time Allowed: 3 hours**

Instructions:

QUESTIONS ARE COMPULSORY

This examination consists of **FOUR (4) questions**. Answer **All FOUR** questions.
The marks for each part of the question are next to the question.
The FINAL exam is worth **50%** of the total course assessment.
Use the Answer Booklet provided to you to answer the questions, and do not forget to write your name, student number and section number in the specified space on the cover of the Answer Booklet.
Write in black or blue ink only.
Do not remove this question paper from the examination room unless the invigilator has given you permission to do so.
You are expected to refer to course materials, provide critical analysis, and use diagrams, illustrations, and practical examples from your own experience, where applicable.
At the end of the examination, candidates must remain seated until the invigilators have collected and checked all the Answer Booklets.
Any form of cheating will NOT be tolerated and will subject you to AOU Cheating Policy.
You should keep the organization of the exam paper neat, use good English, and write clearly using good handwriting.
Any work crossed through will NOT be marked.

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Answer All the following questions:

Question One (25 Marks) (Expected time 25-30 min)

1. Discuss the role of strategic leadership in overcoming barriers to change within an organization. Explain the key bases of power a leader can use to facilitate change.

Question Two (25 Marks) (Expected time 25-30 min)

2. Discuss the benefits and challenges of mergers and acquisitions as methods of diversification. Provide examples of successful and unsuccessful cases.

Question Three (25 Marks) (Expected time 25-30 min)

3. After a strategy is formulated, successful implementation is crucial. A key aspect of implementation is setting up effective strategic control mechanisms to monitor and adjust organizational performance to meet strategic objectives. Discuss the significance of control models in strategy implementation, and propose a model that is well-suited for navigating unpredictable and complex external environments.

Question Four (25 Marks) (Expected time 25-30 min)

4. National prosperity is developed through innovation and strategy, rather than relying solely on natural resources, labor supply, or economic factors like interest rates and currency values. Critically analyze the four components of Michael Porter's Diamond Theory of National Competitiveness, and use relevant examples to illustrate each factor.

End of questions

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